



Unit-6

Self Development and Assessment



Prof. Dhara Tejura

Humanities & Science Department

Darshan Institute of Engineering & Technology, Rajkot

✉ dhara.tejura@darshan.ac.in

☎ 9727747320



Topics to discuss:

- ▶ Change
- ▶ Growth
- ▶ Persist
- ▶ Prioritize
- ▶ Read
- ▶ Learn
- ▶ Listen
- ▶ Record
- ▶ Remember
- ▶ Assess
- ▶ Think
- ▶ Communicate
- ▶ Relate
- ▶ Dream

Change

Change:

“Change is hard in the beginning, messy in the middle and gorgeous at the end.” – Robin Sharma

- ▶ We always look for stability but the only thing that is constant in the world is “Change”.
- ▶ We need to develop ourselves to become better today than yesterday.
- ▶ For example, if a student is not able to study regularly, he scores less than his actual potential and then regrets in the end, “Only if I could have studied regularly!” Here, the student has to work continuously on changing his habits with prioritization, time management, assessment, etc. He has to introspect a lot and find out ways on how to go about it.
- ▶ While ridding ourselves with bad habits, we must remember that it needs to be replaced with one good habit.

- ▶ It is said that if you contribute doing a task every day at the same time for 66 days in a row, then it becomes your habit and then you don't have to exert to do that task.
- ▶ With the development of technology, change in the thinking of people, change in the overall environment, the companies must keep on updating their products, services, ways of dealing with customers and employees, policies and strategies.
- ▶ “Change” is also important for a society as a whole. When an individual brings about a change on oneself, everything around also changes.
- ▶ Rather than complaining we must always strive to bring about that change ourselves. And so, Mahatma Gandhi said, “Be the change you want to see in the world.”

► Six steps to bring about a change:

1. Identify one thing that you need to change.
2. Accept, that you really need to change this one thing.
3. Determine that you will do something to change.
4. Identify the action points to bring about the change.
5. Take action.
6. Persist till you succeed.

Growth

Growth:

"Growth is painful, Change is painful. But, nothing is as painful as staying stuck where you do not belong."- N. R. Narayan Murthy

- ▶ When we change, we grow as human beings. Each time we stretch ourselves, we expand our limits.
- ▶ You can grow only if you move out of your comfort zone.
- ▶ For examples, when you start going to a gym, on first few days, your body will ache, then slowly and gradually your body becomes used to this exertion and it doesn't pain at all. But again if you add the number of exercises, then again it will start paining.
- ▶ This way, every time crossing the boundary of our comfort zone, we can keep on growing in all aspects of our lives. Hence, always try to do a little more than what you had thought to.



Persist

Persist:

"It always seems impossible until it's done." - Nelson Mandela.

- ▶ Persistence is the key to bring about a change and growth in ourselves and our surroundings.
- ▶ It is persistence alone which will make you successful to bring about a positive change in your life. The road upwards is always difficult, and there will come a time when you would want to give up.
- ▶ Take an example of a student who has decided to study for 2 hrs continuously. After half an hour, he will start feeling a little bored and will start looking for distractions. If at that time, his friend comes with an idea of playing, he'll quickly get up and go without completing what he had decided.
- ▶ Persistence is refusing to give up on the face of difficulties and keep on moving forward till the time reach your goal.

Prioritize

Prioritize:

" The key is not to prioritize what's on your schedule, but to schedule your priorities"- Stephen Covey.

- ▶ The reason why people are not able to persist is because they're not able to identify their priorities.
- ▶ “Time management” one must include all priorities in the schedule and work accordingly.
- ▶ When we don’t have our own plans, we end up becoming the part of other people's plans and priorities, thus taking us nowhere.
- ▶ So, priorities your work and make a plan and discard everything which is not in your plan, unless it is very urgent and important.



Read

Read:

"The man who doesn't read has no advantage over the man who can't read". - Mark Twain.

- ▶ Reading is the best habit that everyone must imbibe.
- ▶ It is the literature that helps build the spirit of people.
- ▶ Reading helps in many ways and it is one of the most important elements of self-development.
- ▶ Reading about your own area helps you sharpen your core skills, while reading general books and other topics gives you an idea about all aspects of human life.
- ▶ Whether you read one type of book or the other it is important that you ponder over whatever you already read. This will help you find more meaning from what you read and it will become a part of you.



Learn

Learn:

"Live as if you were to die tomorrow. Learn as if you were to live forever." - Mahatma Gandhi

- ▶ One who continues learning never feels stagnant in life.
- ▶ If we always keep a seeking mind, we'll be able to learn from every situation or person around us.
- ▶ Learning helps us move forward and improvise each time. We can learn from our own experiences, reading about great individuals, history, other's success and failures, etc. No learning ever goes in vain in our lives.
- ▶ A professional must keep on learning new ways of work.
- ▶ You gain a new confidence, every time you learn something new.

- ▶ Learning new skills of your profession helps you keep updated and add to your profile.
- ▶ You will never feel stuck, even in the face of difficulties and you are able to see opportunities in all situations.
- ▶ Every profession provides a scope of learning from time to time with the development of new ideas, innovations and technology.



Listen

Listen:

“Most people do not listen with the intent to understand; They listen with the intent to reply.” – Stephen Covey

- ▶ Listening is the most important of all soft skills.
- ▶ The way we communicate and work, depends on whether we are good listeners or not.
- ▶ What is about to be an empathetic listener?
- ▶ Can be better in every role if one has better listening skills.
- ▶ Listening helps you in learning a lot.

- ▶ Listen to the needs of your surroundings.
- ▶ Makes you a better person and a better professional.

Record

Record:

- ▶ Record-keeping is very important aspect to measure the progress of an individual in organization.
- ▶ Useful for performance appraisal.
- ▶ Helpful in reflecting, measuring, assessing and creating new goals.
- ▶ Record keeping helps like
 - tracking your expenses and budget
 - tracking your professional progress
 - assessing yourself in terms of self-development,
 - remembering from what you learnt etc.
- ▶ Need to maintain records regularly.



Remember

Remember:

- ▶ “remember” word can be seen from a deeper perspective.
- ▶ Example
- ▶ Means to stay committed.
- ▶ Person walks one step ahead everyday towards his goal, only if he remembers it all the time.
- ▶ If you have set your priorities well, you will not forget them.
- ▶ A person who remembers is always needed by others.
- ▶ So, remember to remember.



Assess

Assess:

- ▶ Assessment is very important to see the progress.
- ▶ Provides insights on whether whatever we are doing is correct, in the right direction and intensity.
- ▶ Self – assessment helps in finding out ones own self.
- ▶ Self – assessment gives motivation too.
- ▶ We can say assessing is like measuring our progress and we can do fine tuning with the help of assessment.



Think

Think:

“Concentrate all your thoughts upon the work in hand. The Sun’s rays do not burn until brought to a focus.” – Alexander Graham Bell.

▶ “Thinking” in itself has many perspective.

▶ Different perspective like:

“Don’t think much”

or

“Thinking is waste of time, just act”

or

“Think before you speak.”

- ▶ Firstly, concept of overthinking.
- ▶ Secondly, think a lot but do not act over it.
- ▶ What kind of “thinking” is good?
- ▶ Analyze the situation and give objective reply.
- ▶ Respond rather than react.
- ▶ It is important to keep our thoughts focused on our goal and that is what will make us successful.

- ▶ “think” is the starting point of any action.
- ▶ Involves a critical analysis.
- ▶ Provide objective and implementable solutions.



Communicate

Communicate:

- ▶ Discussed previously in chapter 1.
- ▶ Nothing can be accomplished without communication.
- ▶ Mastering communication skills is a matter of practice.
- ▶ One can receive a lot of new information.
- ▶ It helps in two ways: To sharpen your communication skills
To enhance your knowledge.
- ▶ How you communicate with yourself is also important.
- ▶ Some people suffer from low self-confidence because of wrong self-talk.



Relate

Relate:

- ▶ When you cannot able to relate, not remain for longer time in your mind.
- ▶ So, whatever you read, learn, listen, experience must be related to yourself to remember.
- ▶ It helps in developing new ideas.
- ▶ It helps in critical thinking
- ▶ When we relate, we look at the complete aspect and it helps us coexist with our environment rather than living in isolation.



Dream

Dream:

"If you can dream it, you can do it". - Walt Disney.

- ▶ Your lives are built when you learn to build your dreams.
- ▶ Acts as a guiding path towards the destination.
- ▶ Process to make dream true.
- ▶ Every human being has unique talents and they can do wonders with those talents.
- ▶ Start to work on your interest.

- ▶ There will be something for which you will start feeling proud of and before you realise it becomes your dream.
- ▶ To have a dream or a goal in life is very important otherwise you will never know where to go.